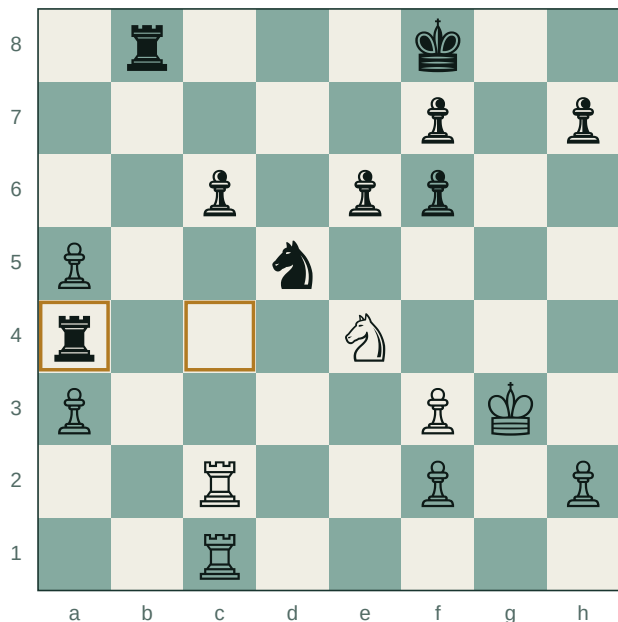


Forks and double attacks: White, move 30

Forks and double attacks

White to move



Previous move: 29...Ra4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Nc5 Rxa5 31. Nd7+ Kg7 32. Nxb8

30.Nc5 The knight moves from e4 to c5. Recorded reply: **30...Rxa5**.

31.Nd7+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From d7 it attacks king on f8 and rook on b8. Recorded reply: **31...Kg7**.

32.Nxb8 The knight captures the rook on b8.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +4: the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8 and rook on a4. Check for tactical protection.